

POLYPORALES

The Polyporales form a large group of diverse fungi. Most of these are polypores – wood decomposers whose spores are formed in tubes (rather like the tubes of the boletes) or sometimes on spines. Most lack fully developed stems and grow shelf-, bracket-, or crust-like fruitbodies on wood, but some have more or less central stems and grow at the base of trees. A few Polyporales appear to grow from the soil.



UPPER
SURFACE

10–30 cm
4–12 in

OAK MAZEGILL
Daedalea quercina
F: Fomitopsidaceae

Found on fallen oaks in Eurasia and N. America, this perennial species has tough brackets with long maze-like pores on the underside.



UNDERSIDE

RAZORSTROP FUNGUS
Fomitopsis betulina
F: Fomitopsidaceae

This large, kidney-shaped bracket is pale brown to white. A damaging parasite of birches, it is found in Eurasia and N. America.



5–30 cm
2–12 in



ARTIST'S BRACKET
Ganoderma applanatum
F: Ganodermataceae

Found in Eurasia and N. America, this woody perennial bracket grows for many years to reach huge sizes. Its fallen spores are a rich cinnamon-brown.

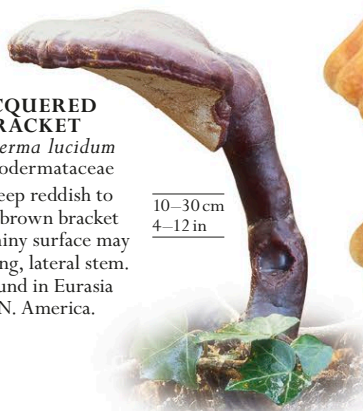


10–50 cm
4–20 in

surface
bruises black

GIANT POLYPORE
Meripilus giganteus
F: Meripilaceae

One of the largest polypores, its overlapping brackets are thick and fleshy. It grows around beech and other trees in Eurasia and N. America.



**LACQUERED
BRACKET**

Ganoderma lucidum
F: Ganodermataceae

This deep reddish to purple-brown bracket with a shiny surface may have a long, lateral stem. It is found in Eurasia and N. America.

10–30 cm
4–12 in

CHICKEN OF THE WOODS
Laetiporus sulphureus
F: Fomitopsidaceae

These large brackets, found in Eurasia and N. America, usually grow on oaks and sometimes on other trees.



margin is wavy
and lobed



bracket grows
in layers

15–30 cm
6–12 in

DYER'S MAZEGILL
Phaeolus schweinitzii
F: Fomitopsidaceae

Usually found at the base of conifers in Eurasia and N. America, this large, furry, cushion-like bracket is used for the manufacture of dye.

10–50 cm
4–20 in

hairy
surface



10–25 cm
4–10 in

RED BELTED POLYPORE

Fomitopsis pinicola
F: Fomitopsidaceae

Occurring in Eurasia and N. America, this hoof-shaped, woody bracket is usually found on pines, and sometimes on birches.

JELLY ROT
Phlebia tremellosa
F: Meruliaceae

Found on logs in Eurasia, this species has a pale, velvety upper side and a yellow-to-orange underside with dense ridges.

4–15 cm
1½–6 in



10–20 cm
4–8 in

ZONED ROSETTE
Podoscypha multizonata
F: Meruliaceae

Growing on soil from buried oak roots, this rare species occurs in Eurasia. It has densely packed lobes that form a circular mass.

3–7 cm
1¼–2¾ in

SMOKY BRACKET
Bjerkandera adusta
F: Meruliaceae

This common bracket, found in Eurasia and N. America, can be identified by the ash-grey pore surface on its underside.

